



desert state is renowned for its temples, forts, and mosques, and also for the arts and crafts produced here, with each principality having its own specialization. Most striking, however, are the colors of Rajasthan. Women wear

dazzlingly bright fabrics studded with embroidery or mirror work and accessorized with quantities of silver jewelry. Men wear colorful turbans, and even working animals and their carts are often vibrantly painted.



POPULATION EXPLOSION

Only 13,000 people live in Pushkar, but during the fair a further 200,000 descend on the town, bringing with them 50,000 camels, horses, and cattle. Most stay in tents, turning the sand dunes just outside this tiny town into an enormous campsite.



SWIRLING SKIRTS

Rajasthani women are famous for their vibrant clothes. During the *ghoomer* dance they twirl gracefully, allowing their skirts to flare out. Most folk dances are performed by groups of men or women, but rarely by both together.



CAMEL FESTIVAL

Camel races and competitions are organized in vast arenas before thousands of spectators. Camel beauty contests also take place, and a version of musical chairs is played in which the winning camel is the one that can support the largest number of people.

Pushkar fair

During the annual five-day festival every November thousands of people, including both Indian and foreign tourists, visit the city. Another tradition has grown up around this event—cattle and camel trading. At least 25,000 camels are brought here to be groomed, admired, raced, and, with luck, sold.

